

Chapter 90-1

Lumi, as the famous "social butterfly"¹ of Minghui Jewelry's Design Department, often exchanged gossip with people.

When Xu Qingzhu saw this message and this photo, her first reaction was: Lumi, shut up!

So she called Lumi. "Hello, Lumi, where are you?"

Lumi ducked into a corner, covering her mouth with her hand as she spoke into the phone: "Director, I-I-I... I didn't see it on purpose."

Xu Qingzhu: "...I know."

"I'm asking where you are?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Lumi answered: "At 'Four Seasons'."

That restaurant name was unique enough.

Xu Qingzhu was only silent for one second before Lumi started spilling everything like beans pouring out of a bamboo tube²: "Director, I came to a classmate reunion tonight, and I just happened to want to use the restroom. Then when I turned the corner, I saw... them... aish!"

Lumi didn't even know how to say it, so she could only come out with something bold: "There are thousands upon thousands of women in the world—if one treats you badly, swap her out every day. Director, you're so outstanding, are you afraid you can't find someone else?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

This wasn't even about finding someone else or not.

Xu Qingzhu helplessly put her hand to her forehead and instructed her: "Delete that photo. Don't talk about this at the company. I don't want my private matters to become gossip fodder for my colleagues."

Lumi was stunned, then immediately said: "Director, what kind of person do you take me for? I can babble nonsense about ordinary gossip, but I would never be careless about something like this, okay? I definitely won't tell anyone. I deleted it after sending it to you. But..."

Lumi paused, then said in a gloomy tone: "Director, are you coming to catch this pair of cheating women?"

Xu Qingzhu: "...No."

Lumi: "???"

She'd heard that wealthy families often had marriages of convenience³. Could it be that the director and her wife were also...

Lumi suddenly felt like she might have been meddling in other people's business.

But she couldn't help it. She'd had the heart of a chivalrous heroine since childhood, always drawing her sword to help when she saw injustice. Having witnessed the director's wife cheating right before her eyes, could she possibly not tell the director?

Of course not!

Lumi would suffer the condemnation of her conscience for it, so she risked getting fired to send that message to Xu Qingzhu.

Of course, the main reason was that the director was usually very good to them.

Although she seemed cold and aloof, the things she did were very warm.

Lumi had been won over by her completely.

Lumi's hesitation made Xu Qingzhu helplessly add: "You can't judge anything from just one photo."

"I saw it with my own eyes!" Lumi said excitedly: "The two of them were embracing!"

"And now?" Xu Qingzhu asked again.

Lumi peeked out again, only to meet eyes directly with Gu Yixue who was walking toward her.

Lumi: "..."

Damn, so beautiful!

Gu Yixue's waist and lower abdomen were exposed. The tank top she wore was very short—remove the two straps and it would be almost like a tube top. Such a seemingly provocative piece of clothing, when worn by Gu Yixue, made her look graceful and elegant, impossible to look away from. You didn't even feel she was being seductive or deliberately enticing.

You could only purely exclaim in admiration: Beautiful.

Beautiful to the degree of meeting the standard of an earthly enchantress.

Gu Yixue slightly raised her eyes to look at her, then carelessly swept a glance over her as she passed by. Lumi felt like all three of her souls and seven spirits⁴ had been stolen away.

It wasn't until Xu Qingzhu called out twice on the other end of the phone: "Lumi?"

Only then did Lumi snap back to her senses. Clutching her heart that was about to leap out of her chest, she complained to Xu Qingzhu: "Wuwuwu! Director! Why aren't you more vigilant!"

"Vigilant?"⁵ Xu Qingzhu's ear went blank for a second. "What vigilance?"

Lumi: "..."

"Director! Please be more careful!"⁵ Lumi said, exasperated at her failure to meet expectations: "That woman is a little vixen! She's too good at seducing people. I don't think your wife cheated on purpose—it's purely because the little vixen outside is too alluring. Director, we're not bad-looking either. With just a little dressing up, we could crush her!"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She sat at home listening to Lumi give her terrible ideas, putting the phone on speaker, while the screen displayed the high-definition photo Lumi had sent her.

In the photo, Liang Shi still had her gentleman's hand⁶—this had always been her habit.

And the other woman had fallen toward her. From a distance, it did look like an embrace, but when you zoomed in, you would discover that Liang Shi had simply reached out to steady her. Although the hand supporting her had landed on her arm, she hadn't gripped back.

After Lumi had talked until her mouth was dry, she finally remembered to ask Xu Qingzhu: "Director, did you hear me?"

Xu Qingzhu: "Got it."

Her tone was lazy. Then she said to Lumi: "Lumi, zoom in on that picture and take another look."

Lumi was startled. "I already deleted it!"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She hadn't realized before that Lumi was this reliable.

But Xu Qingzhu still explained her analysis to her, and said with absolute certainty: "Liang Shi couldn't possibly cheat."

Lumi: "...Why?"

Xu Qingzhu smiled, her cool and clear voice sounding particularly confident over the phone: "Am I not pretty and talented enough?"

Lumi: "..."

My respects!

Footnotes:

¹ **Social butterfly (社牛)**: Short for "社交牛逼症" (social prowess syndrome), internet slang for someone who is extremely outgoing and has no social anxiety, able to talk to anyone about anything.

² **Beans pouring out of a bamboo tube (竹筒倒豆子)**: A Chinese idiom meaning to speak rapidly and tell everything without holding back, like beans spilling out all at once when you tip over a bamboo container.

³ **Marriages of convenience (形婚)**: Short for "形式婚姻" (formal marriage), referring to marriages that exist only in form, often between people who are gay/lesbian and marry someone of the opposite sex (or in this context, someone they don't actually love) to satisfy social or family expectations.

⁴ **Three souls and seven spirits (三魂七魄):** In traditional Chinese belief, humans have three spiritual souls (魂) and seven physical spirits (魄). Saying they were "stolen away" is a dramatic way of expressing being completely captivated or entranced by someone's beauty.

⁵ **Vigilant/Careful (上點心/長點兒心):** There's a pun here. "上點心" can mean both "be more vigilant/pay attention" and "have some dim sum/snacks." Xu Qingzhu deliberately misunderstands and asks "what snacks?" Lumi then rephrases using "長點兒心" which more clearly means "be more careful/wise up."

⁶ **Gentleman's hand (紳士手):** A term referring to the practice of keeping one's hands in a respectful, non-inappropriate position when in close physical proximity to someone, typically hovering near but not actually touching intimate areas—a sign of respectful behavior.